

Florida Veteran Benefits

Worksheet Pack

Companion to the book 'The Florida Veteran Benefits Handbook'.

This is a private study aid. It is not a government form, it is not an official document, and filling it in does not claim any benefit.

Every benefit in the book is claimed on a free form at a public counter: the county property appraiser, the tax collector, the clerk, the wildlife commission, a state park, your college, or a state agency. County Veteran Service Officers help for free. Nobody needs to charge you to file any of it.

Print this pack and keep it with the VA letter and the DD-214. Each sheet corresponds to a chapter, and the chapter explains why it asks what it asks.

Free to copy. County Veteran Service Officers, FDVA staff, veterans' service organizations, and county offices may reproduce and distribute this pack for client use without asking.

What is in here

1. The three lines from your letter - which shelf you're on
2. The county page - your three offices and the other doors
3. Document checklist - which office wants which
4. The homestead year - January 1, March 1, August
5. The one-week route - five stops, one folder
6. The surviving spouse's list - what carries, and what to file

Rules change. Check the date on the book's copyright page, and the book's links page, before relying on anything here.

1. The three lines from your letter

Download the VA benefit summary letter from VA.gov. Read it for these lines and write the answers here. See Chapter 2.

Service-connected disability: yes / no

Combined rating percentage

Totally and permanently disabled (P&T): yes / no

Combat-related disability (if any)

Letter dated

Honorable discharge (DD-214 character of service)

Which shelf that puts you on

- ☐ Any service-connected rating: state parks pass; preference categories; business tax exemption (needs only the discharge)
- ☐ 10% or more: the \$5,000 property tax exemption (s. 196.24)
- ☐ 50% or more: free hunting and fishing license, 5 years (s. 379.353)
- ☐ 100% service-connected: the free DV plate (s. 320.084)
- ☐ 100% permanent and total: the TOTAL homestead exemption (s. 196.081); license fee exemption; FDVA ID card; dependents' scholarship
- ☐ Combat-related and 65+: homestead discount equal to the rating (s. 196.082)

If the letter says 100% but not permanent and total, the total homestead exemption is not yet available. Ask the CVSO about the P&T finding; it is a VA matter.

2. The county page

Your county's offices. Fill in once. The links page carries all 67 counties. See Chapter 4.

County Veteran Service Officer (phone) _____

Property appraiser (web / phone) _____

Tax collector: plates & licenses branch _____

Tax collector: business tax window, or city clerk _____

Clerk of the circuit court, recording _____

Nearest state park entrance station _____

Your college's veterans' office _____

Your residency tests

- ☐ Owned and lived in the homestead on January 1 of this year
- ☐ Florida resident continuously for five years (for the DV plate)
- ☐ If not: declaration of domicile recorded at the clerk (s. 222.17) on: _____
- ☐ Other state's homestead exemption cancelled
- ☐ Driver license and registration show the homestead address

3. Document checklist

Two printed copies and the PDFs, named so a stranger can tell what they are. See Appendix A.

- ☐ VA benefit summary letter, dated this month - Every office; appraiser, tax collector, FWC, parks, DOE, employers, DMS
- ☐ DD-214 - Clerk (record it free, s. 28.222); tax collector; appraiser; employers; college; DMS
- ☐ Certified copies of the DD-214 from the clerk - Everyone, so the original stays home
- ☐ Florida driver license or ID with the homestead address - Appraiser; FWC; parks; every counter
- ☐ Vehicle registration or title - DV plate
- ☐ Declaration of domicile, recorded - DV plate if resident under five years
- ☐ Deed; voter registration; permanent resident card if non-citizen - Property appraiser
- ☐ VA Form Letter 27-333 or physician's certificate, within 12 months - Disabled parking permit
- ☐ VA rating decision showing combat-related - Combat-related discount, DR-501DV
- ☐ Marriage certificate; death certificate - Every spouse and surviving-spouse benefit
- ☐ Joint Services Transcript - College, credit for military training
- ☐ FDVA form VP-1 - Veterans' preference, with the application

4. The homestead year

Own and occupy on January 1. File by March 1 with the property appraiser. Read the notice in August. See Chapter 5.

Closing / move-in date (before January 1?) _____

Homestead application filed (DR-501), confirmation no. _____

Boxes checked: homestead / \$5,000 / total & permanent / combat-related (DR-501DV) _____

VA letter uploaded, dated _____

DD-214 uploaded _____

Exemption shown on the August TRIM notice? (call the appraiser if not) _____

Renewal: automatic in this county? or renewal form returned by _____

If you missed March 1

A petition to the value adjustment board within 25 days of the TRIM notice mailing, showing extenuating circumstances (s. 196.011(9)). The CVSO's territory. And file for next year regardless.

Changes that break the renewal

- ☐ Sale or transfer of title
- ☐ Divorce or death changing who holds the deed
- ☐ Moving your permanent residence
- ☐ Remarriage of a surviving spouse

5. The one-week route

Five stops, one folder, in this order. The clerk before the tax collector, because the domicile declaration unlocks the plate. See Chapter 13.

Day 1, home: VA letter downloaded; DD-214 found; address updated; CVSO called; hunting license applied online	_____	
Day 2, clerk: DD-214 recorded; declaration of domicile filed if needed; certified copies	_____	Free recording
Day 3, tax collector: 'Veteran' designation; fee exemption; DV plate; parking; business tax exemption	_____	One visit
Day 4, property appraiser: homestead application, every box, letter and DD-214	_____	Before March 1
Day 5, a state park: the free pass at the gate	_____	Bring the letter
Any day, the college: waivers, priority registration, credit for training	_____	Each term
Any day, online: dependents' scholarship (DOE); business certification (DMS)	_____	

Dates on the lines. If a counter sends you away, write down what it wanted; that is the note the next veteran needs.

6. The surviving spouse's list

What carries to a surviving spouse, and what has to be filed for it to carry. Keep this with the folder. See Chapter 12.

- ☐ Homestead exemption (s. 196.081(3)): file the spouse's application with the death certificate and marriage certificate before the next March 1; it carries until remarriage or sale and can move to a new residence
- ☐ \$5,000 exemption (s. 196.24) and combat-related discount (s. 196.082): carry on the same terms
- ☐ Veterans' preference, category (d): VA certification of the service-connected death, marriage certificate, FDVA form VP-3
- ☐ Dependents' scholarship (ss. 295.01-.03): spouse and dependent children of a veteran who died from service-connected causes
- ☐ DV plate: does NOT carry; surrender it (s. 320.084)
- ☐ Burial: nine VA national cemeteries in Florida; apply for pre-need eligibility now

Numbers to keep here

Property appraiser

County Veteran Service Officer

Florida Veterans Support Line: 1-844-MyFLVet (693-5838)

Veterans Crisis Line: 988, press 1
